PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

April 25, 2026
Community Engagement Session: School Rightsizing

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Portland Public Schools Board of Education Community Engagement Session was held at Benson High School at 546 NE 12th Ave, Portland, OR 97232, and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Board Members Present: Michelle DePass, Rashelle Chase-Miller, Virginia La Forte, Stephanie Engelsman.

Staff: Jon Franco - Senior Chief of Operations; Margaret Calvert - Assistant Superintendent; Nichole Watson - Senior Director of Family and Community Engagement; Emily Glasgow - Senior Director - P-K Academics; Richard Smith - Senior Director, Data and Accountability.

Call to Order
The meeting was called to order at 2:16 pm.

Welcome + Grounding

Nicole Watson welcomed attendees, oriented them to materials and the agenda for the session. Dr. John Franco provided a welcome and reiterated that there was not already a list of identified schools for closure.

Board members introduced themselves and shared what they hoped to hear from the attendees.

Historical Context

Jon Franco provided the context for the need to consolidate schools, citing declining enrollment and creating well resourced schools in a budget deficient.

Learning Lab Rounds

Participants were able to ask questions of subject matter experts: Emily Glasgow for Academics, and Richard Smith and Margaret Calver for Data. Common themes expressed by participants for what a well-resourced school looks like, included strong and relevant curriculum, adequate adult-to-student ratios, special education supports, schools with librarians along with music and art. There was also a desire for safe and functional facilities, and after-school programming. Participants also expressed the need to increase trust, examine focus option schools and the impact on enrollment, consider expansion of pre-K classrooms in underutilized buildings, concerns about the decision making process, and calls to address state level funding formulas.

Board Remarks

Board Members recapped the themes they heard from attendees and encourage people to attend an upcoming school funding forum.

Closing

Staff shared where polling results would be available as well as information about an upcoming engagement session.

Adjournment

The session ended at 3:31 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
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Portland Public Schools